

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities.

Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms suggest a sudden onset of confusion and memory loss , particularly difficulty recalling recent events and her inability to recall the time . The patient's history of depression and migraines is also noted . However , the absence of head trauma , normal vital signs , and the fact that she is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time are key points to consider . The patient's memory recall is also impaired , as evidenced by her inability to recall objects at 5 minutes . The patient's symptoms of confusion , memory loss , and altered mental status , particularly in the context of her history of migraines , suggest a diagnosis of migraine with aura , which is a type of migraine that can cause transient global amnesia . Transient global amnesia is characterized by sudden , temporary episodes of memory loss , often accompanied by confusion and disorientation . The patient's symptoms align with this diagnosis , making it the most likely explanation for her presentation . </think><answer> D . Migraine </answer>